The Noble Dhāraṇī of the Peaked Palace on the Summit of the Great Vajra Mount Meru

Āryamahāvajrameruśikharakūṭāgāradhāraṇī · Toh 946 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་རྡོ་རྗེ་རི་བོ་ཆེ་ཙེ་དེ་ཁྱེའུ་ཕོ་བྲང་པ་བཙུགས་པའི་གཟུངས།

The Noble Dhāraṇī of the Peaked Palace on the Summit of the Great Vajra Mount Meru, known in Sanskrit as the Āryamahāvajrameruśikharakūṭāgāradhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Phakpa Dorjé Rirab Chenpö Tsemö Khangpa Tsekpé Zung, is a dhāraṇī scripture, a text centered on a sacred incantation believed to carry protective and spiritual power. It opens in the classic manner of a discourse spoken by the Buddha, setting the scene in a magnificent peaked palace atop the great vajra Mount Meru. This realm is described as the ground of the great vajra samādhi, adorned with vajra wish-fulfilling trees, pools of jewel lotuses, and countless lion thrones. Against this richly visionary backdrop, the text goes on to present its dhāraṇī and the benefits associated with it. It is catalogued as Toh 946 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the collection of dhāraṇī texts.

In the language of India: ārya mahā vajra meru śikhar kūṭa gā ra dhā ra ṇī. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dhāraṇī of the Peaked Palace on the Summit of the Great Vajra Mount Meru.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was in the peaked palace on the summit of the great vajra Mount Meru. It was the place that is the ground of the great vajra samādhi. It was beautifully adorned with great vajra wish-fulfilling trees and illuminated by the light of the jewel lotuses in great vajra pools. Its ground was strewn with great vajra sand and blessed as great vajra, and its surrounding courtyard was made of great vajra. It was made beautiful by a thousand hundred thousand koṭis of niyutas of great vajra lion thrones of Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods. It was endowed with the teaching of the Dharma and with miracles, blessed by the blessing of all the buddhas, a place where one enters the sameness of all phenomena and where deliverance comes through omniscience.

He was there together with eighty-four hundred thousand koṭis of niyutas of bodhisattvas. All of them were bound to only one more birth and irreversible from unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. They had attained great power. Through the samādhi of great vajra liberation they made magical

displays in the buddhafields and everywhere showed great miracles. In a single instant, moment and second of mind, they taught a variety of Dharma that accords with the minds and conduct of all sentient beings, a teaching of sameness, melodious, vast and profound. Endowed with eloquence and miracles, they worshipped the tathāgatas in many buddhafields with clouds of great offerings. Every one of them was endowed with the gates of liberation, the dhāraṇīs, the samādhis, the masteries, the superknowledges, the unshared qualities, the factors of awakening, the path, the ten grounds, the perfections, skill in means, the means of attracting disciples, loving-kindness, compassion, joy and equanimity, the power of loving-kindness, solitude, and a continuous stream of thoroughly purified mind. They were the bodhisattva great being called Vajragarbha, Vajranetra, Vajrakāya, Vajramati, Vajrapāṇi, Vajrasamāja, Vajra Great Elder, Vajravikurvita, Vajrakūṭa, Vajrarāśi, Vajranāda, Vajrabhadra, and the bodhisattva great being called Vajraketu. These and others made up the eighty-four hundred thousand koṭis of niyutas of bodhisattva great beings.

There were also a great many great śrāvakas. All of them were arhats whose defilements were exhausted, whose fetters to existence were severed, and whose minds were thoroughly liberated by perfect knowledge. Through the power of miraculous abilities and inconceivable miracles they had attained the great might of magical display. They had no attachment to views, all were free of stains, and every one of them had utterly burned the seeds of the habitual tendencies of the afflictions. They were the venerable Śāriputra, the venerable Pūrṇa Maitrāyaṇīputra, the venerable Kapphiṇa, the venerable Subhūti, the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, the venerable Inciter, the venerable Nandaka, the venerable Gayākāśyapa, the venerable Mahākāśyapa, and the venerable Uruvilvākāśyapa. These and others made up the great many great śrāvakas.

There were countless, immeasurable and incalculable devaputras of the class of the Pure Abodes, led by the devaputra Maheśvara (Śiva). There was Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, and the devaputras of Brahmā's realm, led by the devaputra Subrahmā. There was the devaputra Suyāma together with the devaputras of the class of gods of the Yāma heaven as his attendants. There were Santuṣita, Sunirmita and Vaśavartin, and Śakra, lord of the gods, with a retinue of all the devaputras. There were the asura lords Vemacitrin, Bali, Prahlāda, Rāhu and Vairocana; these and others made up the limitless, countless and immeasurable asura lords. There were the nāga kings Sāgara,

Anavatapta, Takṣaka, the son of Vāsuki, Śaṅkhapāla, Mover of Strength, Padma, Mahāpadma and Ananta; these and others made up the limitless, countless and immeasurable nāga kings.

There was the kinnara king Druma with many attendants who were kinnara kings; the gandharva king Pañcaśikha with many attendants who were gandharva kings; the king of vidyādharas Sarvārthasiddha with many attendants who were vidyādhara kings; the garuḍa king Golden Eye with many attendants who were garuḍa kings; the great yakṣa king Vaiśravaṇa, with Maṇibhadra and Pūrṇabhadra; the yakṣa king Pāñcika with many attendants who were yakṣa kings; Hārītī with a retinue of five hundred sons; the seven mothers of the world; the seven sisters; the seven great sages; the constellations that move through space; all the planetary deities; the gods of the directions; the gods of the intermediate directions; Pṛthivī, the earth goddess; Sarasvatī; the bhūtas; the obstructors; the vināyakas; the pretas; the bhūtas of great miraculous power; all the kings of mountains; the world protector Varuṇa with all the ocean gods as his attendants; Virūḍhaka; Virūpākṣa; Daṇḍapāṇi; Nairṛti; Agni, god of fire; the seven great wind gods; Īśāna with his consort, with a retinue of many hundred thousand koṭis of niyutas of hosts; the Son of Nonexistence with his attendants; the Giver; Garland Bearer; the Iron One; the great Gaṇapati; the cloud Talala; the lord of vināyakas with many attendants who were obstructing vināyakas; the sixty forest deities; the four sisters with their brother; the seven mothers; Vajrāṅkuśa; Vajraśṛṅkhalā; the sixty-four vajra messenger women; Vajrasena; Subāhu; Crown-Goer; together with many retinues of the vajra family. And besides these there were also others who had faith in the Buddha, in the Dharma, and

and the Saṅgha: gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas, bhūtas, pretas, piśācas, unmādas (the spirits who cause madness), apasmāras (the spirits who cause forgetting), sādhakas, together with snake-holders and oppressors, immeasurable, limitless and countless. He was also together with the god's son Sūrya, the Sun, the god's son Candra, the Moon, the deity of the seasons, the deity of the evening, all the deities of time, and the gods of heaven and earth.

At that time the Blessed One had fully turned the wheel of Dharma. He had entirely brought the deeds of a buddha to completion. He had entirely perfected the accumulations of merit and wisdom. He was entirely sustained by his attainment of omniscience, of great awakening, of the perfections and

of the grounds. His body was adorned with the thirty-two blazing major marks of a great being. All his limbs, major and minor, were embellished with the eighty excellent minor marks. The crown of his head could not be seen by any sentient being. He had shaken off all the thorns of Māra. He had realized, stage by stage, the knowledge of suchness. He possessed the five kinds of eyes. He was endowed with the supreme of all aspects, endowed with omniscient wisdom, and endowed with all the qualities of a buddha. He had vanquished Māra, his adversaries, and all the hosts of those with wicked hosts. His spoken words and his verses were exalted. He roared the roar of the bull and the lion. He had dispelled entirely the darkness of ignorance.

He was beautiful, his body adorned with the thirty-two major marks of a great being and the eighty excellent minor marks, brought to completion by practicing, for countless and immeasurable hundred thousands of koṭis of eons, the perfections of generosity, moral discipline, patience, diligence, meditative concentration, wisdom, skillful means, power, aspiration and primordial wisdom, and by austerities. He was seated on a lion throne in the heart of a jeweled vajra lotus.

That jeweled seat, the vajra-lotus lion throne, was as vast as Mount Meru. Many nets of bells and small bells adorned with vajras, jewels and pearls rang out with a tinkling sound. Its base was firmly set upon platforms of many vajras and jewels. It was hung with draperies bearing strings of red pearls that issued from the mouths of makaras made of many vajras and jewels. It was beautiful all around, illuminated by the blazing rays of the many jewels set into the heart of a lotus of many jewels: kekeru jewels, great kekeru jewels, sapphires, great dark-blue stones, and many dunla stones. It was shaded and sheltered by many hundred thousands of koṭis of parasols adorned with ribs of jewels and vajras and raised high on their shafts. It was beautified by many wish-fulfilling trees.

Seated upon that vast throne, the Blessed One blazed with splendor like a mountain of gold. With a maṇḍala of light surpassing a thousand suns, he made the whole region beautiful. Like the full moon, he brought joy to the whole world when it beheld him. Like a great wish-fulfilling tree, flourishing fully with the qualities of a buddha, he taught the Dharma. He taught perfectly the holy life, virtuous in the beginning, virtuous in the middle and virtuous in the end, excellent in meaning, excellent in wording, unmixed, entirely complete, entirely pure and entirely immaculate.

Then from the ūrṇā curl at the border of the crown of the Blessed One's head there issued a great net of light rays called Fully Displaying All Buddha Fields. That net of light rays illuminated this great trichiliocosm, this world system of a billion worlds. By that light, all the buddha fields, as many as the grains of sand in the river Ganges, were also clearly illuminated. And the buddhas, the blessed ones, who dwelt in those buddha fields were likewise teaching the Dharma in multistoried celestial palaces arrayed with many lion thrones. They were together with great śrāvakas and with bodhisattvas, great beings. They were also together with monks, nuns, laymen, laywomen, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. All of them were likewise expounding perfectly the Dhāraṇī of the Peaked Palace on the Summit of the Great Vajra Meru. All of them, too, were visible everywhere.

In that instant all those sentient beings were satisfied with every happiness. The deaf heard sounds. The blind gained sight. The insane recovered their mindfulness. The sick were healed. Pregnant women gave birth with ease. The sufferings of all the beings in the hells came to an end. In that moment not even the names of the animal realm, the realm of the pretas, or the worlds of Yama, the lord of death, were heard. All those spaces between the worlds that lie in darkness and gloom, in great darkness and great gloom, were also clearly illuminated. All the beings born there, and the other beings born here, came to know one another.

Then all those beings attained a wondrous and marvelous joy in the Dharma. Satisfied with supreme bliss, they looked all around and saw the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha. When they saw him blazing with splendor like a golden pillar of offering and exalted by his own majesty, they went to him for refuge. The very moment they went for refuge, all of them felt that they had arrived in the very maṇḍala of the Tathāgata's assembly.

By that light all the abodes of Māra blazed everywhere, blazed intensely, spreading everywhere and blazing, until they appeared on all sides as a single tongue of flame. In that instant the gods of Māra's realm wept with cries of distress and, terrified, fled. Even the wicked Māra's handsome face became haggard and his body broke out in sweat, and he said to all the gods' sons of Māra's realm:

"Friends, look how all the abodes of Māra blaze everywhere, blaze intensely, spreading everywhere and blazing, until they have become a single tongue of flame, and look at the ascetic Gautama teaching the Dharma in the

multistoried palace on the summit of Meru! By him we are undone. We are ruined. There is no direction in which we can find refuge.

"Rise up, go to that ascetic Gautama, and let us destroy him before this domain of Māra is turned to ashes!"

When he had said this, all those gods of Māra's realm said, "Lord, as you command," and went each to his own abode. They took up all kinds of weapons in their hands, put on all kinds of armor, and wore all kinds of attire and ornaments. Their fangs were unbearable and terrifying, their faces were made hideous, and their eyes, faces and hair blazed all over and flared fiercely. In that very instant they gathered together, went to where the evil Māra was, and said to the evil Māra: "Rise, rise! Go before us! So that the ascetic Gautama, together with his Saṅgha of śrāvakas and bodhisattvas, may never again cause even the slightest harm to our domain, and so that our domain may not be harmed, we shall grind him to dust this very day! We shall utterly destroy him!"

Then the evil Māra was delighted and pleased, and every pore of his skin was filled with great joy. In that very instant, together with all the gods of Māra's realm, with a great magical display of Māra and a great army of Māra, he filled the sky for eighty-four thousand leagues. They blew conches and beat drums, clay drums, gongs and great drums, and sounded one-stringed lutes and iron cymbals. They raised cries of "Hu hu!" and "Pici!" and "Seize him! Seize him! Kill him! Kill him!" In their hands they held weapons such as plowshares, pestles, narrow-waisted clubs, daggers, single-pointed vajras, great arrows, short spears, tridents, swords, discs, and bows and arrows. They went to where the Blessed One was, and in that very instant they let out the cry "Alala!" and rained down every kind of weapon on the Blessed One. But by the power of the Buddha, all those weapons appeared to turn into a great cloud of flower parasols. All those sounds of Māra, too, resounded as the sound of the Buddha, the sound of the Dharma, the sound of the Saṅgha, and the sound of right deliberation. The evil Māra saw himself bound by five nooses.

Then all those gods of Māra's realm, seeing that great and wondrous miracle of the Blessed One's magical power, were amazed, were filled with joy, and went for refuge to the Blessed One himself. The evil Māra wished to free himself but could not. In the courtyard of the Tathāgata's assembly, before the Blessed One, he fell like a tree cut at the root, there in the great courtyard of the vajra assembly.

Then at that time the Blessed One, with a mind of great loving-kindness and with eyes moist with great compassion, gazed over the whole courtyard of the Tathāgata's assembly and said to Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets: "Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi, raise the evil Māra from this courtyard of the assembly and set him on a seat. Then teach the samādhi called the Inconceivable Blessing of the Magical Display of the Samādhi of the Great Vajra Door of Liberation, Which Destroys All the Maṇḍalas of Māra, by which these gods of Māra's realm and this evil Māra will go for refuge to the Buddha. Teach also that by which all the others who are hostile, the obstructing spirits, vināyakas, pretas, apasmāras, bhūtas, grahas, ḍākinīs, sādhakas, snake-holders, oppressors, eaters of newborns and the like, who have hostile minds and fiercely hostile minds, who are irreverent toward the teaching of the Tathāgata and have not understood the dharmatā of the Tathāgata, may all be brought in and made to go for refuge to the Three Jewels. Why is that? Because they are headed for a wrongful fall into the lower destinies."

When he had said this, Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, having heard the Blessed One's command, rose from his jeweled lotus vajra seat, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, and placed his right knee on the jeweled lotus heart. Bowing with palms joined toward the Blessed One, he praised the Blessed One with these fitting verses:

"To destroy the afflictions of all beings
The Guide has appeared.
You are victorious over all the māras;
You alone are the world's true friend.
The path that leads into the city of liberation
And wisdom without remainder you alone
Truly found, and then, with a mind
Moist with compassion, you taught.

In the past, through generosity, moral discipline,
Patience, diligence, meditative concentration,
Wisdom and other such qualities,
You perfected yourself, and brought beings in.

You taught that phenomena are unborn,
And likewise analyzed them, and yet
Left no doubt about their result.
Oh, Protector, this is what you taught!

The wheel of twelve limbs
You knew yourself, and fully turned.
Taming the tīrthikas and the māras,
You made the light of Dharma shine clear.

The great rock of afflictions, in every way,
You shattered with the vajra of wisdom,
And found unsurpassed awakening,
Which no one else had ever attained.

You whose very name becomes
The seed of perfect awakening,
You are the world's one supreme being,
The lord of sublime and lavish giving.

You are the protector, you are the father,
You are the refuge, you are the ally.
Great compassion, wisdom itself,
You alone are the abode of nirvāṇa.

You came, and set beings
Free from the hells.
Giving up even your own body,
You protected living creatures too.

The wisdom no embodied being had attained
You found, and then,
Being free, you free the worlds as well.
Oh, you are the excellent friend!

Protector, the net of your light rays
Pervades the realms of the world.
Bliss surpassing even nirvāṇa
You bring all embodied beings to attain.

Overwhelmed by the splendor of your light,
All the planets and the moon in the sky,
The suns and the fires,
And the jewels no longer blaze."

Then Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, having praised the Blessed One with these fitting verses, again sat upon the heart of a jewel lotus. Saying, "Excellent, Blessed One!" he entered into the meditative absorption called the Great Door

of Vajra Liberation, Which Destroys All the Maṇḍalas of Māra.

The moment Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, entered into this meditative absorption called the Great Door of Vajra Liberation, Which Destroys All the Maṇḍalas of Māra, at that very time this great trichiliocosm world system shook in six ways. It quaked and quaked violently all over. When the east rose, the west sank; when the west rose, the east sank; when the south rose, the north sank; when the north rose, the south sank; when the edges rose, the center sank; and when the center rose, the edges sank. All the directions and all the intermediate directions also became filled with joy and delight, and they were radiant, brilliant, and resplendent.

From all the joints of the major and minor limbs of Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, vajras were seen to emerge, blazing all around, blazing intensely, spreading everywhere and blazing, merged into a single flame. By the light of those blazing vajras, throughout the immeasurable, countless, incalculable world systems of the ten directions, wherever buddhas, blessed ones, now dwell, live, and abide, and teach the Dharma, which is good in the beginning, good in the middle, and good in the end, excellent in meaning and excellent in wording, unmixed, completely perfect, completely pure, and completely purified, and rightly reveal the pure conduct, all those buddhas, together with their saṅghas of śrāvakas and their saṅghas of bodhisattvas, and the vast, vast courtyards of their assemblies, were illuminated.

All those bodhisattvas too, in the presence of those tathāgatas, being illuminated by that vast light of blazing vajras, each asked those buddhas, the blessed ones, "Blessed One, whose is this vast light that is present everywhere?"

Then those buddhas, the blessed ones, said this to each of their bodhisattvas: "Sons of noble family, the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Śākyamuni is teaching the Dharma on the summit of Mount Meru in the Sahā world. Seeing that the evil Māra had been bound with the five bonds of the noose and had fallen down before the Blessed One, he said this to the bodhisattva mahāsattva called Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets: 'Vajrapāṇi, Lord of Secrets, display the miracle of the magical manifestation of your own miraculous power!' Sons of noble family, this one has entered into the meditative absorption of the Great Door of Vajra Liberation, and this is the blessing of his great vajra manifestation."

When they had said this, those tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly complete buddhas gave their permission, and all those sons of noble family bowed to those tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly complete buddhas. Through the inconceivable miracle of the manifestation of the bodhisattva mahāsattva, they came to this Sahā world. They made a great offering to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha Śākyamuni, and to Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, with clouds of offerings, clouds of parasols, clouds of ornamental garlands, clouds of crowns, clouds of flowers, and great clouds of garments. Remaining in the middle of the sky, they circumambulated the Blessed One Śākyamuni seven times, placed their right knees upon jewel lotus vajra seats, and, gazing toward the Blessed One, bowed to the Blessed One. Then, with the permission of the Tathāgata, they sat down upon their respective jewel lotus vajra seats.

At that time, in the eastern quarter, in the world system called Vajraketu, the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Vajragarbhapramardin now dwells, lives, and abides, and teaches the Dharma on this very Dhāraṇī of the Tiered Palace on the Peak of the Great Vajra Meru. That light of blazing vajras also illuminated all those world systems, however many they were.

Then in that world system the bodhisattva mahāsattva called Vajragarbha, who had gathered and was sitting in the courtyard of that tathāgata's assembly, saw that marvel and asked the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Vajragarbhapramardin: "Blessed One, whose is such a light of blazing vajras, by which all these world systems have been illuminated, all the sufferings of all sentient beings have been cut off, and all the sufferings of hell beings, of those born as animals, of hungry ghosts, and of the world of Yama are no more? And all those renowned in the world as having great miraculous power and great might, the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, great mahoragas, and the rest, filled with joy and delight, are going toward the west with great clouds of offerings. Whose is this?"

Then the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha Vajragarbhapramardin said this to the bodhisattva mahāsattva Vajragarbha: "Son of noble family, in the western quarter, in the Sahā world, the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Śākyamuni, in the tiered palace on the peak of the great vajra Meru, is teaching the Dharma discourse called the Dhāraṇī of the Tiered Palace on the Peak of the Great Vajra Meru."

That Blessed One sent forth a great net of light rays from the ūrṇā hair at the border of his crown. As soon as that great net of light rays had roused Māra the Evil One in that world realm, he flew into a rage. Together with all the young gods, and the young gods of Māra's class as well, and with a great host of troops, he came to that Blessed One in order to harm him. But by the power of the Buddha he was bound with the bonds of five nooses in that very courtyard of the Tathāgata's vajra enclosure, and he fell down before the Blessed One.

Out of compassion for him, the Blessed One commanded the bodhisattva mahāsattva Vajrapāṇi, Lord of Secrets, "Show it!" Then Vajrapāṇi, Lord of Secrets, entered into the meditative absorption called the Great Vajra Door of Liberation, and from all the joints of his major and minor limbs he displayed vajras. This is the light of blazing vajras from those very vajras.

Son of noble family, that light of blazing vajras illuminated world realms as numerous as the sands of the river Ganges, throughout the immeasurable, countless and incalculable world realms of the ten directions. It roused all the buddhas, the blessed ones, who dwell in those world realms, and it also roused the maṇḍalas of the retinues of those bodhisattvas. Filled with wonder, they each questioned those tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly awakened buddhas. Son of noble family, through the power of that very one, he is also seen sitting before the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly awakened Buddha Śākyamuni, and serving him.

When this had been said, the bodhisattva mahāsattva Vajragarbha said to the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly awakened Buddha Vajragarbhapramardin, "Blessed One, I shall go to the Sahā world in order to behold the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly awakened Buddha Śākyamuni, to pay homage to him and serve him, and also to behold Vajrapāṇi, Lord of Secrets."

When he had made this request, the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly awakened Buddha Vajragarbhapramardin said to the bodhisattva mahāsattva Vajragarbha, "Son of noble family, if you know that the time has come, go."

Then the bodhisattva mahāsattva Vajragarbha, having received the Blessed One's permission, circumambulated the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly awakened Buddha Vajragarbhapramardin seven times and vanished from that world realm. Along the path through the midst of the sky, together with ninety-nine hundred thousand koṭis of niyutas of bodhisattvas, with the great magical display of bodhisattvas and the great miraculous power

of bodhisattvas, he went to where this Sahā world is.

Having arrived, as he conversed with all those bodhisattvas, light rays streamed forth from the jewels bestowed through his accomplishment, which came from gathering a great accumulation of merit. They were of colors such as blue, yellow, red, blue-green, yellow-green, crimson, crystal, silver, jewel, pearl, gold, ruby, emerald, karketana, great karketana, sapphire, great sapphire, dunlé stone, gomutaraka, and red pearl. These rays circled the entire world realm many hundreds of thousands of times, pervaded the space above, and lit it with a divine radiance. Then they gathered together and became like a rainbow, and they circled many hundreds of thousands of times around the two feet of the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly awakened Buddha Śākyamuni. His feet are perfect in every mark, soft and supple, very youthful and full of flesh, glossy, with the veins of the ankles not showing, like a freshly opened lotus, and bearing the marks of a conch, a fish, a vajra, a victory banner, a hook, a lotus, and a makara sea creature. Then the rays dissolved into them.

In the midst of the sky, from the tip of each light ray there emerged eighty hundred thousand koṭis of niyutas of lotuses, each the size of a chariot wheel, made of the seven kinds of precious substance, namely gold, sapphire, silver, coral, crystal, karketana, and dunlé stone.

Of these, the lotuses made of gold had petals made of sapphire, centers made of silver, filaments made of coral, stalks made of crystal, and anthers made of karketana.

The lotuses made of sapphire had petals made of silver, centers made of coral, filaments made of crystal, stalks made of karketana, and anthers made of dunlé stone.

The lotuses made of silver had petals made of coral, centers made of crystal, filaments made of karketana, stalks made of dunlé stone, and anthers made of gold.

The lotuses made of coral had petals made of crystal, centers made of karketana, filaments made of dunlé stone, stalks made of gold, and anthers made of sapphire.

The lotuses made of crystal had petals made of karketana, centers made of dunlé stone, filaments made of gold, stalks made of sapphire, and anthers made of silver.

The lotuses made of karketana had petals made of dunlé stone, centers made of gold, filaments made of sapphire, stalks made of silver, and anthers made of coral.

The lotuses made of dunlé stone had petals made of gold, centers made of sapphire, filaments made of silver, stalks made of coral, and anthers made of crystal.

The rest should be combined in the same way: such were the lotuses, made of many kinds of jewels.

On each of the jewel lotuses, bodhisattva great beings established on the ten grounds, perfect in a wholly beautiful deportment, were absorbed in meditative absorption. From the navel of each bodhisattva hundreds upon hundreds of thousands of light rays streamed forth. From the tip of each light ray there appeared multi-storied palaces made of every kind of jewel. They were encircled by terraces of gems and of many kinds of jewels. On the pinnacles of their turrets, adorned with moons of crystal, jewel standards, flags and victory banners hung from the lion-ear ornaments and covered the whole sky. On the capitals of their great pillars, made of padmarāga ruby, sapphire, emerald, beryl, aśmagarbha, musāragalva and karketana, they were adorned with arrays like sāla trees carved from the gold of the Jambu River, and so made beautiful. At the ends of their silver dove-cornices hung nets of bells and little bells set with red pearls, and the doves, partridges, parrots, mynas and peacocks, woken by their ringing, delighted and exultant, made the palaces charming with their calls. They were made beautiful by courtyards and great assembly halls, ringed by enclosing terraces. They had gateways made of many kinds of jewels, with terraces of crystal, sprinkled with sweet-smelling scented water from many auspicious golden vases.

There appeared great ponds whose banks had lawns of emerald, soft to the touch like kācilindika cloth, and in those lovely places flocks of geese, cranes, ruddy shelducks and kalandaka birds dwelt, resting at ease. Their great embankments were strewn with golden sand and adorned with rows of stairways of the seven precious substances. They were brimming with water of the eight qualities, and they were encircled on all sides by many hundreds of thousands more.

From each pond there emerged ninety-nine hundred thousand koṭis of niyutas of jewel lotuses. In the center of each jewel lotus the sounds of cymbals, hand-clapping and songs rang out, and daughters of the gods sang, danced

and enjoyed themselves. And from those sounds of cymbals, hand-clapping and song, these verses arose:

He who is boundless in generosity and moral discipline,
Endowed likewise with the strength of patience and diligence,
Peaceful through meditative concentration, perfect in mastery:
Go for refuge to that lamp of wisdom!

Endowed with inconceivable powers and aspirations,
Purified by skillful means, the limbs of awakening and the samādhis,
Endowed with the path of liberation and the ten powers:
Go to make offerings to the one who is that Sage!

Just as a lotus blossoms from the mire,
He who is never stained by the mud of the afflictions,
The Victor, protector of the world, who dispels the suffering of death and birth:
Go to behold him, and

He who lacks not even a single quality,
Who has shattered the doors of delusion that bar all beings,
Whose conduct of body, speech and mind is utterly at peace,
The crest of the Śākyas: go for refuge to him!

Thus many hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of palaces of every kind, beautifully adorned with wish-fulfilling trees, appeared throughout the expanse of the sky. In some places rain was seen falling from clouds of jewels. In some, rain fell from clouds of flower parasols; in some, from clouds of gośīrṣa sandalwood, incense, ointments and powders; in some, from clouds of garlands of cloth; in some, from clouds of Kāśi cloth, dukūla cloth and silk; in some, from clouds of wish-fulfilling trees. In some, rain poured down from clouds of flowers: lotuses, blue lotuses, white water lilies, white lotuses, saugandhika flowers, atimuktaka, kācilinda, great kācilinda, Released-and-Held flowers, great Released-and-Held flowers, mañjūṣaka, great mañjūṣaka, māndārava and great māndārava.

The fragrance that arose from those rains of flowers spread through measureless, countless buddha fields, as many buddha fields as there are finest atoms in the sands of the River Ganges. All the sentient beings born into the six destinies in those world systems were satisfied by that fragrance with supreme bliss, and their minds became joyful. Freed from all suffering, they asked one another about it, and from afar they saw the bodhisattva Vajragarbha displaying the manifold miracles of a bodhisattva in the Sahā

world. Having seen him, they bowed down.

As soon as they bowed to that holy being, even those beings who had fallen into the lower realms and the wrong falls attained supreme bliss, joy, delight and faith. In that very instant they were freed from the lower realms and the wrong falls, were born among the gods of the Thirty-Three, and stood in the sky. They worshipped the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha Śākyamuni, the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi, and the bodhisattva great being Vajragarbha with great clouds of offerings. They circumambulated them many hundreds of thousands of times, endlessly and without limit. Then they circumambulated seven times the great courtyard of the Tathāgata's vajra assembly, with all that it held, and the gods descended from the sky. Before the Blessed One, in the many-storied halls of their own jeweled celestial mansions, together with many hundreds of thousands of trillions of goddesses, they sounded cymbals, clapped their hands and sang songs, and they praised the Blessed One with these fitting verses:

Because even the very name of the lower realms, churning with utmost suffering,
Has today been abolished by the power of the Sugata,
And even toward beings who have no merit, the supreme Victor
Acts with loving-kindness: oh, how marvelous and wondrous!

The sinful deeds of every kind, so very grievous,
That we accomplished with our deluded hearts,
How is it that today, by the Sage's bounty, suddenly,
In a single instant, they have been utterly destroyed!

Just as the sun destroys all darkness and gloom,
Just as a blazing fire burns up cloth,
And just as the cold wind scatters clouds like cotton,
So the Sugata has destroyed the sins of beings.

If one sees, hears or remembers the Sugata's son,
His net of rays of innate mastery steals away sin;
He is ever endowed with a mind that dismantles
The elaborations of existence for all beings, and he knows no weariness.

Eyes and head and heart, flesh, blood and fat,
Life, loved ones and children they cast away like grass;
Their hearts moistened with compassion for the sake of beings of every kind,
To those sons of the Protector of the World I bow.

To starving hungry ghosts, water and food of a hundred flavors,
And likewise to people whose hearts long for wealth,
He acts with compassion and satisfies them in various ways:
In that supreme bull among bodhisattvas I take refuge.

They make even the Avīci hell utterly cool,
So that the hell-beings in supreme heat become cool;
Not looking to their own happiness, their minds strive for the good of beings:
To that peerless son of the Protector of the World I bow.

They are freed from the faults of existence, of wandering through existence;
Though they teach emptiness, they do not discard the results of karma;
Though they burn impurities with the fire of wisdom, they are moistened with compassion:
To that mighty one of unfathomable conduct I bow.

Oh, glorious Vajragarbha, son of the Sugata,
Marked with the major marks, from whose body many thousands of lights arise,
With fragrances and many kinds of song you have refreshed us;
In an instant, from hell-beings we have become lords among the gods of the Thirty-Three.

Whatever vast virtue we have gained today
Through reverent praise of the Victor and likewise the Victor's sons,
And of the supremely peaceful Dharma that they have spoken,
By it may the whole world swiftly attain the state of a sugata!

Having thus praised the Blessed One with fitting verses, and the Blessed One having given his permission, they sat in the many-storied halls of their own jeweled celestial mansions, seated to one side in order to listen to the Dharma.

Then the bodhisattva great being Vajragarbha, having displayed this great miracle of a bodhisattva's magical power, worshipped the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha Śākyamuni, the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi, and the great courtyard of the Tathāgata's vajra assembly, with all that it held, with great clouds of offerings. He arose from that samādhi, descended from the sky, and together with those bodhisattva great beings circumambulated many hundreds of thousands of times, endlessly and without limit. He placed his right kneecap upon the heart of a jeweled lotus, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, and gazed at the Blessed One. All those sons of

noble family as well, joy and delight having arisen in them, likewise gazed at the Blessed One. Having gazed, with voices sounding as one, they praised the Blessed One with these fitting verses:

With many arrows of wisdom shot from the bow of mindfulness,
You have vanquished the four mighty māras, whom none could strike,
And having dispelled the darkness of the world's afflicted distress,
Unsurpassed one, you shine clear like the cloudless moon.

With a net of the many rays of the sublime Dharma that vanquish delusion,
You open the lotus beds of those to be tamed;
Your stainless, blazing form in the vast sky of wisdom,
Like the sun, scorches the hosts of Māra who bring torment.
You defeat all the pride of the tīrthikas,
And wholly pacify every burning torment of beings' desire.
You who make the great nourishing sap of virtue's harvest truly increase,
Please send down the rain of virtue and proclaim it like thunder.
Protector, you defeat the hundred jackals of the tīrthikas,
Conquer the māras, and fully attain supreme awakening;
Mighty through the power of truth amassed unmixed,
Fully freed from the fear of birth, you roar just like a lion.
Your conduct profound and steadfast, ever beyond measure,
Become a haven for beings, you spread the jewels of the powers and of samādhi.
Held within the stainless Meru of Dharma and the mountains of discipline,
You, supreme ocean of wisdom, are the foremost lord of all creatures.
Its root of excellent moral discipline, watered by giving, has grown;
It is beautiful with branches sprouting the flowers of love and patience;
Those who long for the fruit of the limbs of awakening and the path resort to it:
Wish-fulfilling tree of merit, from where have you come today?
Your limbs adorned with the thirty-two blazing major marks,
Encircled by the excellent minor marks, precious crystals,
The stakes of the grounds, the masteries and the sacred pledges firmly driven in,
Unmoving like Mount Meru, you are beautiful to beings.

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Vajragarbha, together with those bodhisattva great beings, praised the Blessed One with these verses that poured forth like a shower, and, with the Blessed One's permission, sat to one side on the center of a jewel lotus. All those sons of noble family likewise took

their seats on the centers of jewel lotuses in order to hear the Dharma.

The passage is to be applied in the same way. Thus, in the south, from the world realm called Source of Glory, the buddha field of the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha King Proclaimed by the Heaped Essence of Glory, the bodhisattva, the great being called Vajraketu, surrounded and preceded by many hundreds of thousands of millions of billions of bodhisattvas, came here to this Sahā world, and so on, up to where, with the Blessed One's permission, he sat to one side on the center of a jewel lotus together with those sons of noble family.

Likewise, in the west, from the world realm called Sukhāvatī, the buddha field of the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha Amitāyus, the bodhisattva, the great being called Avalokiteśvara and the bodhisattva, the great being Mahāsthāmaprāpta, surrounded and preceded by many hundreds of thousands of millions of billions of bodhisattvas, came here to this Sahā world, and so on, up to where, with the Blessed One's permission, they sat on the center of a jewel lotus, and all those sons of noble family likewise took their seats on the centers of jewel lotuses in order to hear the Dharma.

Likewise, in the north, from the world realm Source of All Happiness, the buddha field of the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha Supreme Dharma Ascertained by Its Own Nature, the bodhisattva, the great being called Ratnaketu, surrounded and preceded by many hundreds of thousands of millions of billions of bodhisattvas, came here to this Sahā world, and so on, up to where, with the Blessed One's permission, he sat on the center of a jewel lotus, and all those sons of noble family likewise took their seats on the centers of jewel lotuses in order to hear the Dharma.

Likewise, in the northeast, from the world realm Heap of Glory, the buddha field of the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha King Fully Radiant Lord of Infinite Qualities, the bodhisattva, the great being called Sthiramati, surrounded and preceded by many hundreds of thousands of millions of billions of bodhisattvas, came here to this Sahā world, and so on, up to where, with the Blessed One's permission, he sat on the center of a jewel lotus, and all those sons of noble family likewise took their seats on the centers of jewel lotuses in order to hear the Dharma.

Likewise, in the southeast, from the world realm Free from Doubt, the buddha field of the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete

Buddha King of the Banner of Indra's Crest, the bodhisattva, the great being called Sumati, surrounded and preceded by many hundreds of thousands of millions of billions of bodhisattvas, came here to this Sahā world, and so on, up to where, with the Blessed One's permission, he sat on the center of a jewel lotus, and all those sons of noble family likewise took their seats on the centers of jewel lotuses in order to hear the Dharma.

Likewise, in the southwest, from the world realm Jewel Heap, the buddha field of the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha Overpowering with Jewel Might, the bodhisattva, the great being called Ratnamati, surrounded and preceded by many hundreds of thousands of millions of billions of bodhisattvas, came here to this Sahā world, and so on, up to where, with the Blessed One's permission, he sat on the center of a jewel lotus together with those bodhisattva great beings in order to hear the Dharma, and all those sons of noble family likewise took their seats on the centers of jewel lotuses in order to hear the Dharma.

In the same way, from the nadir, from the world system Padmavyūha, the buddha field of the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha King of the Lord of Mountains Well Established on a Precious Lotus, the bodhisattva great being called Gaganamati, surrounded and preceded by many hundreds of thousands of millions of billions of bodhisattvas, came to this Sahā world, and so on, up to where, with the Blessed One's permission, he sat upon the heart of a precious lotus, and all those sons of noble family likewise took their seats upon the hearts of precious lotuses in order to hear the Dharma.

In the same way, from the zenith, from the world system Where Māra's Thorns Are Scattered, the buddha field of the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha Glory Victorious in Battle, the bodhisattva great being called Victorious over Māra's Obscurations, surrounded and preceded by many hundreds of thousands of millions of billions of bodhisattvas, came to this Sahā world, and so on, up to where, with the Blessed One's permission, he sat upon the heart of a precious lotus, and all those sons of noble family likewise took their seats upon the hearts of precious lotuses in order to hear the Dharma.

Then, at that time, because the bodhisattvas displayed many miraculous manifestations of their magical power, this great trichiliocosm, this Sahā world, became beautifully adorned with celestial palaces, with clouds of

flowers, clouds of jewels, and clouds of sand, with incense, ointments, parasols, victory banners, flags, and clouds of banners of victory, with clouds of musāragalva gems, aśmagarbha stones, beryl, sapphire, coral, emerald, red pearls, and gold from the Jambū River, with wish-fulfilling trees, and with pools covered with many precious lotuses.

Just as with this world system, so in the world systems of the ten directions, numbering immeasurable, countless, inconceivable, incalculable, unfathomable, and inexpressible, far exceeding the grains of sand of the Ganges River, everything appeared likewise beautifully adorned through the blessing of the miraculous display of the samādhi of the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi called the Great Gateway of Liberation.

All the tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly complete buddhas who dwell, live, and abide in those world systems, while remaining where they were, stretched out their right hands. Those hands were golden in color, soft, supple, and most youthful, the surfaces of their fingers tender and soft like lotuses and young shoots. They were adorned with the marks of a parasol, a victory banner, a hook, a vase, a fish, a gateway, a celestial palace, a conch, a vajra, a lotus, the śrīvatsa, and a wheel. They were embellished with the excellent minor marks brought forth as the result corresponding to their having perfected the perfection of generosity over many hundreds of thousands of millions of billions of lifetimes. Their nails were copper-colored, prominent, glossy, and thin, and their wrists were made beautiful by the flower-like rays of light with the luster of jewels. With these hands, which accord with the bestowal of fearlessness on all beings, they stroked the crown of the head of the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi in order to encourage him and to delight him. At one and the same time, with a single tone of voice, they made it heard throughout all the world systems, saying these words:

"O son of noble family, in order to subdue and destroy Māra the evil one, as well as all the fierce obstructors and vināyakas, of ferocious mind, who have no faith in the teaching of the Tathāgata and are hostile to it and who have set out to cut off the roots of virtue of all beings; likewise to encourage and to gladden even those bodhisattva great beings who have only just generated the first resolve, whose minds are faint-hearted and who wear the armor of unsteady diligence, and so on, up to bringing even all beings belonging to the three realms to the attainment of nirvāṇa; and so as not to sever the lineage of the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha, you have entered into the samādhi of the Great Gateway of Vajra Liberation. It is adorned with the major

marks and excellent minor marks accomplished through the perfection of an inconceivable accumulation of merit and wisdom. It is accomplished through the power of samādhi, empowerment, dhāraṇī, the powers, the factors of awakening, and the eightfold noble path. It fully pacifies the suffering and the afflictive obscurations of all beings. It draws out without remainder the thorns of Māra, the fear of beings falling into the hells, into birth as animals, among the hungry ghosts, and into the world of Yama. And it gives rise to many marvelous and wondrous joys in the delighted assemblies of gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas, monks, nuns, laymen, laywomen, and others. Excellent, excellent!"

In this way those buddhas, the blessed ones, encouraged the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi. Having gladdened him, they each drew back their hands and sent their own bodhisattva great beings to this Sahā world to hear the Dharma. Being permitted by them, all those bodhisattva great beings bowed to those tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly complete buddhas. Then, by the great blessing of the bodhisattvas' miraculous display and the bodhisattvas' great magical power, in a moment, an instant, a split second, in the time it takes a strong man to stretch out his bent arm or to bend his outstretched arm, they arrived in that Sahā world, and so on, up to where, with the Blessed One's permission, they took their seats to one side upon the hearts of precious lotuses.

Then the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha Śākyamuni, at that time spoke these words to Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets: "Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi, release this evil Māra from this binding by the vajra noose. Act so that he will by all means go for refuge to the Buddha, go for refuge to the Dharma, and go for refuge to the Saṅgha. Act also so that all the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas, humans and nonhumans, as many as there are, will abide in the teaching of the Tathāgata, and so that, having entered the teaching of the Tathāgata, they will by all means come to understand it fully. Do it in this way!"

When he had said this, Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, heeding the Blessed One, said to him, "Excellent, excellent!" He bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet, and then once more entered into the samādhi called Great Gate of Vajra Liberation That Conquers All the Maṇḍalas of Māra.

As soon as Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, had entered into the samādhi called Great Gate of Vajra Liberation That Conquers All the Maṇḍalas of Māra, at that

very time this great trichiliocosm, this world system of a billion worlds, shook in six ways: it moved, moved strongly, and moved strongly everywhere; it quaked, quaked strongly, and quaked strongly everywhere.

Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, also became a single blazing flame. He blazed, blazed intensely, and spread and blazed everywhere. He bared terrifying fangs, sharp, fierce and searing, that stirred great dread. Pressing down on his fangs, his beard yellow like a great flame, he appeared utterly terrifying. Fearsome, he blazed with fire as though wreathed in garlands made of hosts of venom-spewing serpents hanging from his ears, of serpents shaped like a cow's ear and like a ladle, and of fierce blazing poison pouring from the tips of the fangs that came out of the gaping mouths of great snakes.

In his many thousands of hands he held a vajra, a noose, a club, a narrow-waisted club, a sword, a wheel, an iron chain and other weapons. With the light of the sparks streaming from the tips of those weapons he terrified the hostile and fiercely hostile beings found within this great trichiliocosm: yakṣas, rākṣasas, pretas, piśācas, mātṛkās, bhūta grahas, obstructors, vināyakas and the rest. Wearing the bloody skin of a lion, king of beasts, as his lower garment, girded crosswise and tightly with the body of a great snake, more terrifying than terror itself, frightening even the Lord of Death, he became a wrathful one with a body that seemed to contain the whole of the three realms.

And from all the joints of his body there came forth wrathful ones of many colors, namely blue, yellow, red, white and black, all of them of vajra nature. From the expanse of their foreheads, furrowed with wrathful frowns and adorned with uneven wrinkles, rough drops of dust like sparks trickled down. From these, venomous serpents of every kind emerged everywhere, so that they bore the sign of having their limbs and lesser limbs entwined by them. They appeared as fierce vajra beings. From their gaping mouths, unbearable with fangs, burst the horse-laugh "ha ha." Then there came forth the sound hūṃ, deep and steady. It was like the churning ocean heaving with great waves when it is filled to the brim by thick torrents of rain pouring down from rain clouds whipped up by the wind at the time of the world's destruction, and like the fire that issues from the mouth of the mare beneath the sea. At that sound the roaming hosts of bhūtas were terrified and frightened; they scattered, dispersed and panicked, and they went for refuge and bowed down.

When they beheld those bodies, blazing brighter than a thousand suns, they saw cheeks made beautiful by the light of the crest jewels of various serpents coiled within the deep hollows of the nostrils of a hooked, squat nose. They saw masses of hair, rough and tawny and standing on end, their tips adorned, intermingled and lit up by the rays from eyeballs yellow and red like a thousand lightning bolts gathered together. They saw a thousand serpent hoods forming a parasol, and bodies adorned with necklaces, belts, armlets, bracelets and earrings made of serpents of every kind. In their hands they held blazing vajras, stainless, fierce and unbearable.

From their fingers came forth great lion's roars of hūṃ that menaced all obstructors and vināyakas. From their eyes and mouths, out of masses of great sound like thunder, there appeared the light of masses of great blazing flames. By that, the hostile obstructors, vināyakas and the rest were burned, stupefied and cut to pieces: the violent ones with violent minds, the wicked ones with wicked minds, and the hostile ones with hostile minds. They were made to experience feelings that were unbearable, fierce, harsh, painful and unpleasant. Tormented by these feelings, they went for refuge to the Three Jewels.

At that time the evil Māra saw those obstructors and vināyakas, tormented by great feelings, going for refuge to the Three Jewels. He became afraid, terrified and frightened. Finding no refuge, he trembled and trembled violently like a tree shaken by a fierce wind. Though he wanted to weep, he could not weep, and his whole body became motionless, like a figure in a painting.

Then, through the power of the Buddha, Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, set about subduing the evil Māra. He entered into equipoise in the meditative absorption of the great gate of vajra liberation, which destroys all hostile ones, grahas, obstructors and vināyakas, and all the maṇḍalas of Māra. Abiding in that form, he sent forth from his two feet these two wrathful ones, blazing and terrifying to behold, fierce in form, with the great lion's roar called hūṃ. Like meteors, the two flew far into the middle of the sky. Staying in the sky, with great force they circumambulated the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly awakened Buddha Śākyamuni many hundreds of thousands of times, endlessly and without limit, and they spoke these words to Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets: "Son of noble family, command us what we should do!"

Then Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, remained silent, and from the center of his forehead he sent forth yet another. This was a vajra wrathful one of greatly

terrifying form, his mouth gaping, frightful with fierce, unbearable fangs, his lips twisted savagely. His mouth was filled with the lion's roar called hūṃ, like the fierce roar of the great ocean when it is churned by the thunder of masses of black clouds driven by the scattering force of the violent winds at the destruction at the end of time. He made all obstructors and vināyakas flee in terror, losing heart and losing their bearings. His hands and feet, his nails and eyes, his body hair and all the hair of his head appeared as blazing vajras, so that he filled every world system of the great trichiliocosm. With his own splendor he outshone the splendors of all splendor and drove them far away. With that light of blazing vajras he made the light of the constellations, the planets, the stars and the jewels no longer glow, no longer gleam, no longer shine. Even the sun and moon, with their great miraculous power, renowned for their great might and great strength, he made no longer glow, no longer gleam, no longer shine. Apart from the light of the tathāgatas and the light of the bodhisattva mahāsattvas established on the ten levels, he made all other light dim.

Then that vajra wrathful one circumambulated the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly awakened Buddha Śākyamuni many hundreds of thousands of times, endlessly and without limit, and with the Blessed One's permission he spoke these words to Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets: "Son of noble family, command me what I should do!"

Then Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, spoke these words to those great wrathful ones, the vajra wrathful ones: "O holy beings, this very day make the evil Māra take refuge in the Three Jewels! Make him abide by the sacred pledge! Furthermore, whatever hostile ones, grahas, obstructors, vināyakas and the like there are, violent and with violent minds, evil and with evil minds, hostile and with hostile minds, and all who do not enter the Tathāgata's teaching, who do not understand it and do not have faith in it, make them abide in the Tathāgata's teaching! That will bring long-lasting benefit, help and happiness to all sentient beings."

When he had said this, those great wrathful ones, the vajra wrathful ones, having heard the words of Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, accepted the Tathāgata's teaching. At one and the same time, with a single voice, they filled the great trichiliocosm far and wide with the great lion's roar called hūṃ, and they spoke the foundations of the secret mantra:

Homage to the Buddha.
Homage to the Dharma.
Homage to the Saṅgha.
Homage to the seven perfectly awakened buddhas, together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas, pratyekabuddhas and bodhisattvas.
Homage to the great commander of the yakṣas, fierce Vajrapāṇi.
Homage to the great king of vidyā-mantras, Vajrāṅkuśa.
Homage to Vajraśṛṅkhalā.
Homage to the Vajra Thunderbolt.
Homage to Vajravega.
Homage to the Vajra Club.
Homage to the Red-Limbed Vajra.
Homage to Mahābala.
Homage to Vajravidāraṇa.
Homage to the Soaring One.
Homage to the sixty-four vajra messenger women.
Homage to the vajra wrathful ones.

tadyathā oṃ traṭa traṭa troṭaya troṭaya sphuṭa sphuṭa sphuṭala sphuṭaya spoṭaya sphaṭaya moṭa moṭa moṭaya moṭaya ghūrṇṇaghūrṇṇa ghūrṇāvaya ghūrṇṇāpaya sarva satvāni trasa trasa trāsaya trāsaya bhrama bhrama saṃbhrāmya saṃbhrāmya sarvabhūtāni kuṭaya kuṭaya saṃkuṭaya saṃkuṭaya sarva śatrūṃ ṇaṃ gtaṭ ghaṭ saṃghaṭya saṃghaṭaya sarva vyidyā vajra vajra sphoṭaya vajra vajra kaṭa vajra vajra maṭa vajra vajra ucchāṭaya vajra vajra hana vajra vajra daha vajra vajra paca vajra vajra mātha vajra vajra utsādaya mahāvajra vajra thāra vajrapāṇi vriya kaha kaha hasa hasa mahāṭaṭṭahasa

In some versions: You who, with the lion's roar of hūṃ, deep and terrifying like the churning waves of the ocean, strike terror on every side into the hostile and the fiercely hostile, into obstructors and vināyakas: please destroy all the hostile ones, please grant their destruction. hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ vajra para prada sphoṭa

You who drive out and scatter the hosts of gods, asuras, mahoragas, yakṣas, rākṣasas, pretas, piśācas, mātṛkās, bhūtas and grahas that are to be subdued: hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ he he phaṭ amogha phaṭ

Please cause the gods of the realm of the Four Great Kings to tremble, together with their houses and homes, their children and wives, their livestock and their kin. hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ Please cause them to scatter. hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ

Please cause the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three to tremble, together with their houses and homes, their children and wives, their livestock and their kin. hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ Please cause them to scatter. hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ

Please cause Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, to tremble, together with his house and home, his children and wives, his livestock and his kin. hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ

Please cause the gods of the Yāma heaven to tremble, together with their houses and homes, their children and wives, their livestock and their kin. hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ

Please cause the gods of Tuṣita heaven to tremble, together with their houses and homes, their children and wives, their livestock and their kin. hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ

Please cause the gods of Sunirmita to tremble, together with their houses and homes, their children and wives, their livestock and their kin. hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ

Please cause the gods of Vaśavartin to tremble, together with their houses and homes, their children and wives, their livestock and their kin. hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ

Likewise, please cause the gods of Clear Light (Ābhāsvara), and those from Brahmā's realm up to Akaniṣṭha in the realm of the Pure Abodes, to tremble, together with their houses and homes, their children and wives, their livestock and their kin. hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ Please cause them to scatter.

Please paralyze the accomplished holders of knowledge mantras. Please make them stupefied. Please make them bewildered. Please twist them, please cut them. Please demolish them, please utterly demolish them. Please crush them. hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ

oṃ Wrathful one, great wrathful one, many-hued, tawny, black, red and yellow, invincible, ever-blazing wrathful one!

suru suru suru muru muru muru turu turu turu ghuru ghuru ghuru dhuru dhuru dhuru thara thara thara bhara bhara hara hara yara yara mara mara kuhu kuhu cili cili mili mili luṭu luṭu sarva ṭālā mama hūṃ pulu pulu lentam lohasi lentama mulu laṅkhāse culu culentam malu khubu lentam malu rubi kurbi burba leṇyuspura ghaṇyuspu biricu suru suru muru muru sumu sumuru akaṭe bikaṭe nikaṭe kaṭa bikaṭe nikaṭe kaṭaṅkaṭe jaye pijaye jayanti bijayanti timiṅgisi mahātimiṅgisi ghutaṅgame ghutabarāyaṇe

You who discipline the hostile, who tame the untamed, who put the violent to flight, the hero among heroes, the gentle among the gentle, who bring to accomplishment what is not accomplished, who keep what is accomplished from going to waste, who benefit all sentient beings, who are proclaimed by name by all the tathāgatas, who honor and serve all the buddhas, who are blessed by all the knowledge mantras of the vajra family: come here, come here!

In the tiered palace on the peak of Vajra Meru, in the presence of the Blessed One, before all the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas and the rest, whatever pledge you made, please keep it, please keep it. Please come, please come swiftly. Please accomplish my tasks swiftly, swiftly.

Homage to the one who terrifies, the vajra holder, Vajrapāṇi! huru huru Fierce one of attainment, Vajrapāṇi, give your command! svāhā To the one who brings perfect accomplishment, svāhā To the great vajra, svāhā To the vajra peg, svāhā To the vajra destroyer, svāhā To the one blessed by the vajra, svāhā To the vajra kīli kīla, svāhā To the fierce kīli kīla, svāhā To the red kīli kīla, svāhā To the youthful kīli kīla, svāhā To the one blessed by all the buddhas, svāhā Please put an end to all that harms me, to all contagion, and to all epidemics! svāhā

Then, when the great vajra wrathful one had spoken these words, this great trichiliocosm shook in six ways, and in all the directions and intermediate directions, and likewise in the sky, great vajra meteors like cudgels were seen to fall. A great sound as of the sky shattering also resounded.

All around, this great earth appeared to be cracking open everywhere. From those fissures in the great earth, streams of water endowed with the eight qualities gushed upward. Those streams of water, like the waters at the time of the world's destruction, appeared to fill the whole great earth completely. All the great nāgas, great gods and great asuras who dwell beneath the earth emerged from below the earth, came forth at the foot of Mount Meru, rose upward, and went to the Blessed One for refuge.

Then the bhūtas, obstructors and vināyakas who were present, violent ones filled with violent intent and hostile ones filled with hostile intent, also blazed all around, blazed intensely, blazed fiercely on every side, and found their own bodies being utterly crushed by flames that had merged into a single blaze. Tormented by suffering that was unbearable, fierce and harsh, they let out

wailing cries of "Ha ha!" and spoke these words: "Lord of Secrets, since we are about to lose our very lives in an instant, please protect us from this great terror into which we have fallen!" And just like these obstructors and vināyakas, all those who dwell in all the other world realms, and in mountains, rivers, ponds, pools, charnel grounds, trees, thickets, old wells, drinking places, crossroads where four ways meet and where three ways meet, ruined temples, shrines and sanctuaries of the gods, all cried out together: "Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi, please protect us from this great terror into which we have fallen! Please protect us!"

In the same way, all the abodes of the gods shook, shook violently, shook violently on every side, and appeared everywhere dim and without light. All the dwellings of Māra also blazed all around, blazed intensely, flared and blazed fiercely on every side, and appeared to have become a single mass of flame. All the sons of the gods of Māra's class, too, were terrified by the great vajra wrathful ones, and seeing their own heads being shattered by vajras, they went for refuge to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the Perfectly Complete Buddha Śākyamuni, and to the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi.

The evil Māra also, afflicted by an extremely painful feeling, frightened and dejected, terrified by the harm, went for refuge to the Buddha, went for refuge to the Dharma, and went for refuge to the Saṅgha. He bowed to the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi and spoke these words to those great wrathful ones, the vajra wrathful ones: "Sons of good family, protect me! Protect me! Until I sit at the heart of awakening, I go for refuge to the Buddha. I go for refuge to the Dharma. I go for refuge to the Saṅgha. For the sake of all sentient beings I give rise to the mind set on awakening, so as to become like a father, like a mother, like a brother, like a friend and like a blood relative to them. From this day onward I shall become father, mother, brother, friend and blood relative to all sentient beings. Whatever action of body, speech and mind I perform, however slight, I dedicate entirely so that all sentient beings may attain unsurpassed wisdom. Having found relief myself, I shall bring relief to others as well. Having been liberated myself, I shall liberate others as well. Having passed beyond sorrow myself, I shall lead others beyond sorrow as well. Even with my bones, marrow, blood, flesh, vigor and life, I shall serve all sentient beings. I shall make offerings to them. I shall revere them. To the buddhas and bodhisattvas, to the noble śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and to all teachers and those in the place of gurus, I shall also offer service and honor. I shall pay them respect. I shall serve them. I shall make offerings to them."

Then, when the evil Māra had taken up going for refuge in the Three Jewels and had given rise to the precious awakening mind, the entire assembly was filled with wonder. Overjoyed, they spoke with a single voice these words:

"Since you, Māra,
For the happiness of all beings,
Have given rise to the mind of unsurpassed awakening,
We rejoice in it.
Through this precious mind, before long
May you become a buddha, a guide,
And lead all beings in deep suffering
Beyond sorrow.
Just as this supreme Victor does,
Tame all living creatures.
Together with Mahābala,
Tame the four māras."

When they had spoken thus, that whole great assembly, through the power of the Buddha, found handfuls of flowers in their own cupped hands. They scattered those handfuls of flowers over the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the Perfectly Complete Buddha Śākyamuni, over the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi, over those great wrathful ones, the vajra wrathful ones, over the bodhisattva, the great being Vajragarbha, and over the bodhisattvas, the great beings gathered from the world realms of the ten directions. And through the power of the Buddha, those flowers turned into a great celestial palace of flowers.

Then the evil Māra was filled with supreme bliss. As he meditated on the recollection of the Buddha, through the power of the miraculous ability that was the ripening of his own merit, and by contemplating the Tathāgata, there appeared before him a great jeweled celestial mansion. It was hung in an eightfold checkered pattern with many wish-fulfilling trees. It was beautifully adorned with nets of jewels, gems, pearls, conch, crystal, coral, emerald, beryl, indranīla sapphire, great sapphire, karketana, great karketana, diamond, great diamond, dunlé, great dunlé, and gold from the Jambu River. It was well ornamented with parasols, victory banners, pennants, and raised banners of victory, and strewn with garlands of flowers. It was made fragrant with the sweet scent of incense from many censers and anointed with fragrant powders. In it many hundreds of thousands of goddesses played cymbals, beat drums, sang, and danced. All around it was made beautiful by lotuses of

various jewels, kumuda flowers, white lotuses, and utpalas, and by the supreme fragrance that rose from the midst of many hundreds of thousands of pools filled with water of the eight qualities.

Supreme joy, delight, and gladness arose in Māra. With all reverence he took up the mansion, and with Māra's great power, Māra's great magical display, and Māra's great miraculous ability, he raised it in both hands to the crown of his head. He offered it in joy and worship to the spiritual friend, the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi, and praised him with these fitting verses:

"You who hold sway over the worlds, rich in mastery,
Supreme son of the One with the Ten Powers, endowed with the highest,
Relying on you, for the sake of awakening, I have gained
The mind of awakening, stainless and free of attachment,
Like a treasure that brings about the happiness of beings.
My eyes, once stained by the darkness of delusion, are now stainless.
My attachment to existence is fully stilled and free of elaboration.
You have shown me the straight path to nirvāṇa.
All the unbearable hells of the mind have been fully stilled.
Not having gone for refuge to the sinless protector of the world,
Alas, how long was I, wretched one, deceived!
Today, from the sons of the Lord of Sages, I have gained
Merit, faith, compassion, and samādhi. How wondrous!
May I swiftly attain buddhahood, alone upon an earth of a single hue.
Alone I shall bring all beings without exception beyond sorrow.
In other existences, as my mind roams and plays everywhere,
May it never be parted from pursuing its true welfare or from the spiritual friend."

Then the evil Māra, having praised the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi with these fitting verses, fell silent.

Then the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi spoke these words to the great wrathful ones, the vajra wrathful ones: "Sons of noble family, make all those hostile ones, grahas, obstructors, and vināyakas take up the samaya of the Tathāgata, so that they will not harm any beings in their undertakings, will not create obstacles, and will go for refuge to the Three Jewels. Sons of noble family, grant them fearlessness as well. That will bring about the benefit, welfare, and happiness of all beings, and they too will attain unsurpassed nirvāṇa."

When he had said this, the great wrathful ones, the vajra wrathful ones, said "Excellent!" to the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi and rejoiced in his words. Then they went on to address all the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas, and the rest; all the hostile obstructors, vināyakas, mātṛkās, pretas, piśācas, bhūtas, grahas, apasmāras, pūtanas, kaṭapūtanas, vetālas, ḍākas, sādhakas, and snake-holders, and the rest; and all those hosts of grahas. In a loud, forceful, and sustained voice, like the roaring of a great, deep, swirling ocean churned by the falling of many great vajras, they spoke these words:

"Hostile bhūtas, grahas, obstructors, vināyakas, and the rest, you violent ones with violent minds, you sinful ones with sinful minds, you hostile ones with hostile minds, all of you listen! From this day on, you shall not create obstacles for any beings who have entered the teaching of the Tathāgata, nor for any others who practice or recite secret mantras, and you shall not harm them. You shall grant them power in accordance with their practice. You shall protect those beings who have not entered the samaya. You shall grant them peace and well-being, freedom from punishment, the neutralizing of poison, the destruction of poison, and success in vidyā-mantras. Even if they have eaten honey, dregs, garlic, onions, torma, or the meat and food of bhūtas and of the impure, you shall not hold it against them as a fault or count it as an offense."

Then the passage from "all the hostile bhūtas, obstructors, vināyakas, and the rest" up to "spoke these words with a single voice" is to be supplied.

"Sons of noble family, we shall act just as you command. From this day on we go for refuge to the Buddha, the Blessed One, to the Dharma, and to the Saṅgha. For the sake of all beings we generate the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening."

Then the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi said "Excellent!" to the great wrathful ones, the vajra wrathful ones, and to all those hosts of hostile obstructors, vināyakas, bhūtas, and grahas. He had them take up all the rites of the vidyā-mantras, the samayas, and the mudrās. The Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi then arose from the samādhi of the great gateway of vajra liberation.

Then the venerable Śāriputra spoke these words to the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi:

"Son of noble family, abiding in what did you display a miraculous display such as this? What is the name of this samādhi through which even the evil Māra generated the mind set on awakening, and through which, moreover, all the

hostile grahas, bhūtas, obstructors and vināyakas were established in the sacred commitment and made to take up the awakening mind?"

When he had said this, the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi said to the venerable Śāriputra, "Reverend Śāriputra, this samādhi cannot be realized through names, letters, sounds or words. Why is that? Whether name, form, shape, location, meditative equipoise or distraction, there is no phenomenon whatsoever called 'samādhi.' Reverend Śāriputra, in that where there is no name, no form, no shape, no location, no meditative equipoise and no distraction, what do you think: what name should this samādhi be given?

"Moreover, Reverend Śāriputra, this illuminator does not illuminate itself, does not illuminate another, and does not illuminate both. Nevertheless, there is the designation 'illuminator.' Here, the illuminator is empty of the nature of an illuminator; self is empty of self; other, too, is empty of the nature of other; and both, too, are empty of the nature of both, because they are falsely imagined. The two-syllable phrase 'What is this?' is also empty of the nature of a phrase, and its syllables, too, are not syllables. In this way one comes to realize the meaning of dependent origination. When that meaning is expressed, although it comes from nowhere and goes nowhere, because it rests on what is dependent on another there is also the designation of syllables. Because it is wholly imputed, the imputed is empty. Because it is dependently originated, the dependent itself is empty. Because it arises from causes and conditions, dependent origination, too, is empty. Because it is adventitiously produced by causes and conditions, arising, too, is empty of the nature of arising.

"Here, dependent origination is empty of its own characteristic. Whatever is empty of its own characteristic is without characteristic. Whatever is without characteristic is suchness. Whatever is suchness is unerring suchness. Whatever is unerring suchness is suchness that is not other. Whatever is suchness that is not other is samādhi. Whatever is samādhi is realization. Whatever is realization is emptiness. Whatever is emptiness is insight. Whatever is insight is calm abiding. Whatever is calm abiding is liberation. Whatever is liberation is the path of the Middle Way.

"In the path of the Middle Way there is no single extreme and there are no two extremes. There is no grasped object, no grasper and no grasping. There is no annihilation and no permanence, no arising and no cessation, no thought and no conceptuality, no self-dependence and no dependence on another, no

going and no coming, no total affliction and no purification, no meeting and no parting. That is insight. In insight there are no aggregates, no elements, no faculties, no sense sources, no objects, and no designation as objects; there is no karma and no result of karma. That in which there is no karma and no result of karma is unsurpassed, perfect awakening. Whatever is unsurpassed, perfect awakening is the unsurpassed, perfectly awakened Buddha. Whatever is the unsurpassed, perfectly awakened Buddha is the Dharma. Whatever is the Dharma is neither born nor dies. Whatever is neither born nor dies should be understood to be equal to space."

The venerable Śāriputra said, "Son of noble family, this explanation of the teaching of samādhi that you have given is extremely profound. If even all the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas have no access to it, what need is there to mention worldly tīrthikas and all opponents? This Dharma discourse is difficult to understand for all who have not generated roots of virtue and who have little faith; it is otherwise beyond everyone, except insofar as it has become the domain of the Tathāgata's eye. And the Tathāgata's eye is without reference point and without abiding."

When he had said this, the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi said to the venerable Śāriputra, "Reverend Śāriputra, what is called 'Tathāgata' is the characteristic of suchness. Whatever is the characteristic of suchness is emptiness. In emptiness there is no Tathāgata. There is no characteristic of a Tathāgata."

Śāriputra said, "Son of noble family, if the Tathāgata is without characteristic, how then is he taught to be endowed with the thirty-two major marks of a great being and called 'Tathāgata,' his body beautifully adorned with the eighty excellent minor marks? How should the arrangement of the Tathāgata's three bodies be viewed? How did the Tathāgata become fully and perfectly awakened to unsurpassed, perfect awakening?"

The Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi said, "Reverend Śāriputra, what is called 'the thirty-two major marks of a great being' is a conventional verbal term. What is called 'adorned' is the letters and sounds of conceptual elaboration. What is called 'the excellent minor marks' has the characteristic of the essential nature of an illusion and a dream. What is called 'perfect awakening' has the characteristic of the essential nature of space. What is called 'the arrangement of the three bodies' has the characteristic of emanation through the two accumulations.

"Moreover, Reverend Śāriputra, this is the secret domain of the Tathāgata's body. Here, what is called 'the secret of the body' has the characteristic of being the concordant outcome of great merit. Whatever is the concordant outcome of merit is the Tathāgata's body of perfect enjoyment, and this too is the activity of the Tathāgata's body and the secret of the body. Reverend Śāriputra, what is called 'speech' has the characteristic of both the conventional and the ultimate. Whatever has the characteristic of both the conventional and the ultimate is the Tathāgata's emanation body."

It realizes that dependent origination proceeds without annihilation and without permanence. It is entered by way of the path of mental consciousness. It should be known as what is to be cultivated through meditative concentration. Whatever is without an object of focus, empty of both affliction and purification, not a domain of the body, not a sphere of speech, and not a domain of the mind's own nature, that is the Dharma body of the Tathāgata, fully gathered into the element of space. The establishment of the three bodies of the Tathāgata should be viewed in this way.

Reverend Śāriputra, furthermore, whatever is the secret of the Tathāgata's body is the Dharma body. Whatever is the Dharma body is to be seen as the middle path of phenomena. Whatever is the middle path neither arises nor dies. Whether tathāgatas appear or do not appear, this Dharma body simply remains.

Reverend Śāriputra, what is called "the concordant outcome of merit" belongs to the category of the perfections. And what is called "perfection" is also to be seen as the concordant outcome of merit itself. Why is that? Reverend Śāriputra, what is called the perfection of generosity is to give away completely the two kinds of things, outer and inner. Here "outer" is a conventional term, and "inner" is an ultimate term. Here "outer" means giving food to those who want food, and drink to those who want drink, and likewise giving male servants, female servants, workers, hired laborers, elephants, horses, chariots, land, one's head, hands, feet, eyes, flesh, blood, marrow, fat, and even one's bones. Moreover, it is giving that is embraced by the perfection of skillful means and fully dedicated, that does not hope for karmic ripening, that is excellent and abundant, and that is done with respect, in every way, to all sentient beings. This is outer giving.

Inner giving is the gift of the Dharma. It too is twofold. It is to be wholly intent on entering into dependent origination, and it is talk of generosity, talk of

moral discipline, talk of patience, and talk of diligence, concentration, wisdom, skillful means, power, aspiration, and primordial wisdom, embraced by compassion and included within the perfection of skillful means. Furthermore, inner giving is this: to abandon grasping at extremes, conceiving of arising and cessation, conceptual thought, and both knowledge and the knowable, embraced by joy and included within the perfection of power. This is the gift of the Dharma.

With regard to this very thing, to be free of excitement and free of conceit in body, speech, and mind, to be without distraction of body, without distraction of speech, and without distraction of mind, embraced by the perfection of wisdom, to dwell single-pointedly without affliction, embraced by equanimity, included within the perfection of skillful means: this is the perfection of moral discipline.

With regard to this very thing, to have no regard for one's own body and life, and to abandon the things of merit and non-merit, of Dharma and non-Dharma, of truth and untruth, of the moving and the unmoving, embraced by loving-kindness and included within the perfection of wisdom: this, here, is the perfection of patience.

To be enthusiastic in mind and to set to work in order to attain generosity, moral discipline, patience, and meditative absorption, to be constantly without dwelling and never weary, and not to take even that as an object, embraced by loving-kindness and included within the perfection of primordial wisdom: this, here, is the perfection of diligence.

Reverend Śāriputra, this is the accumulation of merit, which accomplishes the secret of the body of perfect enjoyment of the Tathāgata.

Reverend Śāriputra, furthermore, the accumulation of wisdom is the realization of these very four perfections. It distinguishes the perfections, connects them, and clarifies them, and, being intent on them, it genuinely teaches impermanence, selflessness, emptiness, healing, healing, the absence of entities, and all entities as being without entity. In brief, dispelling attachment, aversion, delusion, the afflictions, and the secondary afflictions, it genuinely teaches the realm of phenomena as equal to the sphere of infinite space. Being free of any object of focus, this, here, is the perfection of meditative concentration. Whatever is suchness, emptiness, the emptiness beyond extremes, the emptiness of the final limit, and the very own nature of the realm of phenomena: this, here, is the perfection of wisdom. Reverend

Śāriputra, this is the accumulation of wisdom.

The accumulation of merit and the accumulation of wisdom, these two accumulations, bring about the full realization of the factors of awakening, of knowledge, of all that can be known, and of unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Reverend Śāriputra, this is the secret of the Tathāgata's body taught in brief. As for its extensive analysis, even if the Tathāgata himself were to remain for an eon as the measure of his lifespan, teaching and explaining it, he would not come to the end of it. Just as it is with the secret of the body, so too is it with the secret of speech. As for the secret of mind, the Tathāgata does not undertake to teach it by way of aspects, individual aspects, colors, signs, shapes, the domain of verbal conceptuality, or the applications of various activities. Nevertheless, the Tathāgata's individual self-awareness should be known to be the secret of mind.

Venerable Śāriputra, for that reason this should also be understood in this way through this presentation. What need is there even to speak of teaching by those like us, who have not yet fully awakened to perfect awakening? Nevertheless, through the blessing of the Tathāgata, I shall explain a little, putting forward a single, merely partial door by which one may enter. I do so for the sake of the boundless and endless realm of sentient beings, whose intentions, superior intentions, inclinations, intellects, understandings, realizations and aspirations are boundless and endless. Their domains follow the many different streams of mind. They have various places of birth and various co-emergent karmas. They live in the darkness of unknowing and ignorance, in invisibility and pitch blackness, in the five destinies and the six destinies. They live in the three realms, in their beginning, their middle, and their dwelling in destruction, abiding without interruption from the prior limit to the later limit, confused about the three times and the directions. Day after day they are crushed by birth, aging and the rest, by sickness and disease, by sorrow and lamentation, by suffering, mental unhappiness, agitation and the like.

I do so in order to ferry across those in the realm of beings who have not crossed over, to liberate those not liberated, to give relief to those who have found no relief, and to bring to complete nirvāṇa those who have not completely passed beyond sorrow. I do so in order to lead them into this Dharma discourse, to establish them on the path by which every state is transformed, and in nirvāṇa, which is supremely blissful, ultimate, peaceful, untroubled, virtuous and free of illness. I do so in order to join them to

omniscient wisdom endowed with the supreme of all aspects, which, through the equality of the expanse of the self-cognizing wisdom of the buddhas, the blessed ones, is equal to the unequalled. I do so in order to have them truly take hold of it, to truly praise and extol it, and to make them truly delight in it, and in order to establish them firmly on the ground of joy, faith and contentment. I do so in order to express the distinctive features of realizing the Dharma, and, like the great ocean, never to let pass the time and the measure for ripening the beings to be trained. On that account I do so for their sake, for the benefit, welfare and happiness of the great multitude of people, and for the benefit of gods and humans. I do so in order that the unsurpassed Dharma way of the Great Vehicle may remain, handed down from one to the next. I do so in order that, by transmission given from one to the next, the continuity of the lineage of the wisdom arising from hearing, reflection and meditation, and of gnosis made habitual so that it has become yoga, may not be cut off. And I do so in order to ripen fully those who have the fortune but are not yet fully ripened, and who are fit to be ripened.

When he had said this, the venerable Śāriputra was supremely amazed and filled with wonder. Overjoyed, he said to Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets:

"Son of good family, excellent, excellent! Because you have made clear such a meaning of the words of the profound Dharma to śrāvakas like us, who have only limited knowledge and follow the sound proclaimed by others, son of good family, you have done well."

Vajrapāṇi said, "Venerable Śāriputra, it is so; it is just as you have said. Venerable Śāriputra, as for your question, 'What is the name of this samādhi?', the name of this samādhi is the Great Vajra Door of Liberation."

Then the Blessed One stretched out his right hand, golden in color, soft, supple and most youthful. He placed his right hand on the head of Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, and uttered these inspired words:

"Vajrapāṇi, Lord of Secrets, excellent, excellent, that you have revealed, explained, unravelled and analyzed such a profound sūtra as this for all sentient beings, in accordance with the meaning of the secret words!"

Just as the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha Śākyamuni gave his "Excellent!" to Vajrapāṇi, so too all the tathāgatas belonging to the world systems of the ten directions placed their hands on the head of Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets. They too uttered these inspired words and gave their "Excellent!", saying, "Son of good family, in many world

systems even to hold the name of this Dharma discourse is rare. What need is there to speak of fully illuminating it?"

When Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, explained this Dharma discourse, in sons of the gods whose number far exceeded the finest particles of the sands of immeasurable, countless, incalculable Ganges rivers, the stainless and immaculate Dharma eye regarding phenomena arose. A great many monks, nuns, laymen and laywomen, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas, humans and nonhumans attained acceptance of the nonarising of phenomena. Even more sentient beings than these generated the mind set on unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening, so as to become irreversible. This great trichiliocosm, and other buddha fields beyond it, immeasurable, countless, inexpressibly inexpressible, shook in six ways. For Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, out of joy in the Dharma and as an offering, drums resounded everywhere in the midst of the sky without being beaten. In the many-storied chambers of the bodhisattvas' miraculous celestial palaces, cymbals were played on every side, hands were clapped and songs were sung, and the daughters of the gods danced.

Clouds raining down flowers poured down on every side: incense, unguents, fumigants, scented powders, garments, parasols, victory banners, flags, wish-fulfilling trees, jewels, garlands of pearls, lotus flowers, kumuda and utpala lilies, the finest fragrances, jasmine flowers, pāriṣaka and great pāriṣaka, Released-and-Held and great Released-and-Held, mandārava and great mandārava, mañjūṣaka and great mañjūṣaka, and All-Arising and great All-Arising flowers. Clouds raining down scented water poured down as well.

Then Brahmā, Viṣṇu, Maheśvara (Śiva), Śakra (Indra), the world guardians, the yakṣas, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, the hosts of mātṛkā grahas, the bhūtas, the apasmāras, the skandas, the sādhakas together with the serpent-holders, the oppressors, the mātṛkās, the pretas, the piśācas, the brahmarākṣasas, the ḍākinīs, the gods of the directions and the intermediate directions, of towns and of mountains, the earth gods and the rest, the hostile grahas and obstructors, all the vināyakas, and others besides, gods, humans and nonhumans, draped their upper robes over one shoulder and set their right knees on the ground. Bowing with joined palms toward where the Blessed One was, they said this to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, please teach us this heart of your own, by which we will be pressed and hard pressed, so that we grant accomplishments to all holders of

vidyā-mantras and give our full consent to their entering all the pledges."

Then the Blessed One gave his "Excellent!" to Brahmā and that whole host of gods: "Friends, because you have set out in this way for the benefit of all sentient beings, it is excellent, excellent! Therefore listen well and keep it in mind, and I shall let you hear my own heart." And they in turn said to the Blessed One, "Excellent, excellent!"

Then the Blessed One, with a voice like a great divine drum, like the ocean, like a great cloud; a voice surpassing the voice of Great Brahmā, manifold, melodious, vast and deep; good in the beginning, the middle and the end; agreeable to the hearts of all sentient beings; clear, refined, pure, soft and sweet; words that make themselves understood throughout all the three realms; with that unsurpassed lion's roar of the Tathāgata, spoke these foundations of the accomplished secret mantra:

Homage to all the tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly complete buddhas!

tadyathā jaya jaya jayavaha cili cili mili mili luṭu luṭu jaye vijaye jayanti vijayanti ajite aparājite tadyate sarva duṣṭa praduṣṭa stamabhani jambhani mohani śvete karāle keyūre sarva buddha adhiṣṭhite bandharā vāsini parṇa śabari śriye mahā śriye sarva addhūta ya śrite padma bahe padma mālini vajra aṃkuśi vajra māte vajra pātāli śūlini vajra dhare hi hi hi hi vajra pāṇi he he he he vajra pāṇi vajra śūliṇi cakra dhare hi hi vajra pāṇi he he vajra pāṇi hi hi hi hi he he he he vajra pāṇi kala kala bala bala rala rala dhama dhama sara sara hā hā hā hā hā cili mele chile dile didila dimile jvale mahā jvale jvaliti prajvaliti thara thagge thare mukuti kṣame kṣamame

You who are saluted by the hosts of the accomplished, you who enter into the hearts of all the gods, you who pierce the hearts of all sentient beings, you who crush the hearts of all the hostile and the most hostile, you who protect the heart of all the tathāgatas, you who enter into the heart of all the bodhisattvas, come here! Uphold the pledge! Summon the hearts of all sentient beings and set them in the pledge!

Homage to the Omniscient One, svāhā.
Homage to all who know the world, svāhā.
traṭa traṭa sphoṭaya svāhā.
To the one who looks upward, svāhā.
To the one who looks all around, svāhā.
To the makara, svāhā.
To humans, svāhā.

To Brahmā, svāhā.
To Viṣṇu, svāhā.
To the Rudras, svāhā.
To Śakra, svāhā.
To the world guardians, svāhā.
To all, svāhā.
To the gods, svāhā.
To the Vasus, svāhā.
To the mātṛkās, svāhā.
To the ancestors, svāhā.
To all obstructors and vināyakas, svāhā.
To the earth, svāhā.
To Sarasvatī, svāhā.
To the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, all the mahoragas, the rākṣasas and the rest, to all sentient beings belonging to all the three realms, svāhā.

Come here, come here! Uphold the pledge!

kuru kuru sara sara tiṣṭha tiṣṭha hana hana daha daha paca paca hūṃ yūṃ pūṃ caṇḍali mataṅgi ḍompini bukkasi

Homage to all the tathāgatas! May the foundations of secret mantra be accomplished for me, svāhā.

When the Tathāgata spoke this heart of his own, this heart of all the gods, that entire divine assembly was terrified and seized with fear. Like a grove of plantain trees shaken by a great and violent wind, as though cut off at the root, they trembled and shook, and their hearts burned. As if struck by vajra stakes, they were pierced and shattered, and they rolled about. In order to seek refuge, by mere thought they called upon the Buddha, the Blessed One, and the Blessed One said this to Vajrapāṇi, Lord of Secrets:

"Son of noble family, raise up this divine assembly. I shall have them take up this pledge. I have proclaimed the heart devoted to bringing success in the accomplishment of vidyā-mantras."

When he had said this, Vajrapāṇi, Lord of Secrets, raised up that whole divine assembly with this secret heart:

Homage to the Three Jewels! Homage to the fierce Vajrapāṇi, great general of the yakṣas!

oṃ kili kila bāla kili kilāya svāhā

"Blessed One, this is my supremely secret heart. It brings about the accomplishment of all vidyā-mantras. Drawn by it, even I come, and no one else can send me away.

I come under its power. I shall grant accomplishments. I shall act as instructed. I shall protect. I shall bring about glory. I destroy all obstructors and vināyakas. I shall tame all sentient beings. I shall destroy all bhūtas. I shall dispel all illnesses. The ripening of former karma alone is excepted.

Blessed One, three incalculable eons ago from now, while I was engaged in great austerities, I was tormented by all the harmful obstructors and vināyakas. At that time the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, Holder of the Supreme Ocean, Whose Mind Is Vast like Fire, Sporting Freely, Glorious Light of the Sweet Fragrance of Higher Knowledge, gave me this most secret heart essence of mine for my protection.

As soon as Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, had spoken this most secret heart essence, that entire assembly was satisfied with the joy and bliss of meditative concentration, and they abided in the teaching of the sacred commitment of Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets.

Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Ānanda, "Ānanda, take up this Dharma discourse! Keep it! Read it! Have others retain it! Master it thoroughly! Teach it to others as well, extensively and correctly! By this, many sentient beings will have benefit and happiness for a long time, and in the end they will attain and realize the unsurpassed wisdom of the Tathāgata, free of attachment and free of obscuration.

"Whoever bears this Dharma discourse, reads it, has others retain it, masters it thoroughly, teaches it to others as well, extensively and correctly, makes offerings to it, writes it out, has it written out, recites it, listens to it, and reflects on it will before long awaken fully into unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening. From now until they sit at the seat of awakening, they will not go to the lower realms or to wrong destinies. They will not be born into low families, nor into poor families. They will not lack wisdom, they will not be untamed, and they will not be short-lived. In life after life they will remember their former lives. They will not forget the awakening mind. They will retain

what they have heard. They will delight in deep solitude. They will not have bad companions. Their words will be worthy of acceptance and pleasant to hear. They will have good fortune and a fine form. They will possess great wisdom, great eloquence, and power. They will become skilled in pleasing all the tathāgatas. They will be cared for by spiritual friends. They will completely abandon evil companions. They will become skilled in perfecting the perfections. They will become skilled in bringing all sentient beings to perfection. They will have miraculous powers in vast and boundless buddha fields. Until they sit at the seat of awakening, they will not forget the awakening mind.

"In this very life they will not be overpowered by any obstructors, vināyakas, accomplished vidyādharas, bhūtas, hosts of grahas, mātṛkās, pretas, piśācas, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas, or the like. All their karmic obscurations will be purified. They will be free of all illnesses. Except for the ripening of former karma, they will not meet their time of death. For them all vidyā-mantras will be accomplished. All the gods will guard, shelter, and fully protect them. All their undertakings will be easy. They will enter the sacred commitments of all maṇḍalas, both worldly and transcendent."

Then the venerable Ānanda said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, what is the name of this Dharma discourse? How should it be held?"

The Blessed One said, "Therefore, Ānanda, hold this Dharma discourse as The Teaching That Is a Cloud of Offerings of All Bodhisattvas. Hold it also as The Turning of the Unobscured Wheel of Dharma of All the Tathāgatas. Hold it also as Skill in the Tathāgata's Dharmadhātu. Hold it also as The Destroyer of All the Maṇḍalas of Māra. Hold it also as The Taming of Māra's Faction. Hold it also as The Full Realization of Entry into Dependent Origination. Hold it also as The Characteristics of the Seal of the Sacred Dharma. Hold it also as The Establishment in All Vidyā-mantras, Maṇḍalas, Mudrās, and Sacred Commitments. Hold it also as The Miracle of the Samādhi of Vajrapāṇi's Liberation. Hold it as The Dhāraṇī of the Great Vajra Mount Meru Peak Pavilion."

Then the venerable Ānanda said "Excellent!" to what the Blessed One had spoken, and, rejoicing, fell silent.

Then all the bodhisattva great beings of the Fortunate Eon, headed by Maitreya; all those bodhisattva great beings, headed by Vajragarbha, who had

gathered from the world systems of the ten directions; all those gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas, humans, and nonhumans; that whole assembly praised what the Blessed One and Vajrapāṇi had spoken.

This completes the noble Dhāraṇī of the Great Vajra Mount Meru Peak Pavilion.

It was translated and edited by the Indian preceptors Śīlendrabodhi and Jñānasiddhi and the chief editor and translator, the venerable Yeshé Dé, and was then revised according to the new terminology and finalized.

Translator's Notes

• Several names could not be identified with confidence and are translated by meaning: the bodhisattvas "Vajra Great Elder" (the Tibetan reads rdo rjes thu bo che, possibly for rdo rje'i thu bo che) and Vajravikurvita (a likely reconstruction of "Vajra Magical Display"); the śrāvaka "Inciter"; the nāga king "Mover of Strength"; the garuḍa king "Golden Eye"; and the deities "Son of Nonexistence," "the Giver," "Garland Bearer," "the Iron One," "the cloud Talala," and "Crown-Goer." Daṇḍapāṇi ("Club in Hand") is a probable reconstruction. "Masteries" renders dbang, which here stands among the bodhisattva qualities (Skt. vaśitā) and does not mean empowerment. The Tibetan reads "the son of Vāsuki" (nor rgyas kyi bu), and this is kept as written.
• "Snake-holders" and "oppressors" are rendered literally because their Sanskrit equivalents are not certain. "Sādhakas" renders sgrub pa, here apparently a class of spirits; the identification is tentative. Of the jewel names, "great dark-blue stones" and "dunla stones" are uncertain identifications. The light is said to come from the ūrṇā "at the border of the crown," which is unusual, since the ūrṇā normally lies between the brows; it is translated as written. In the list of ten perfections, ye shes, the tenth, is rendered "primordial wisdom" to distinguish it from shes rab, "wisdom," the sixth.
• The Tibetan reads □□□□□□□□□□□□, literally "not having heard the command". Vajrapāṇi immediately responds to the Buddha with homage, so this is taken as a slip for □□□□□□□□□□□, "having heard the command."

The sentence explaining the purpose, □□□□□□□□□□□□

• The text reads "in order to be chief" (gtso ba'i phyir). This makes little sense here, and I have read it as the similar gtse ba, "to harm." The identity of the gem called dun las is uncertain, so I have kept it as "dunlé stone." "Gomutaraka" follows the Tibetan transcription of an unidentified gem name. The Sanskrit form Vajragarbhapramardin is a reconstruction of the Tibetan "Crusher by Means of the Vajra Essence." The sentence beginning "through the power of that very one" seems to report the buddhas' answer to the bodhisattvas' question, and its subject is unstated. It is most likely Vajrapāṇi.
• The text reads □□□□□□ where the parallel phrases have □□□□□, and □□□□□□□□□□ where □□□□□□ "displaying" is plainly meant. The evident readings are translated. In the lotus count, □□□□□□ is written twice, apparently a dittography, and "ninety-nine" is given.

Several bird and flower names are uncertain. □□□□□ is rendered "partridges" tentatively, and □□□□□□□□ is taken as saugandhika. □□□□□□□□ could not be identified with confidence and is translated literally as "Released-and-Held," consistent with the rest of the text. The "arrays like sāla trees carved" on the pillar capitals may refer to śālabhañjikā figures.

□□□ in the first verse is taken in the sense of the bodhisattva's masteries (vaśitā), not ritual empowerment. □□□□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered "asked one another." The object of their questions is implied, presumably the source of the fragrance.
• In the prose, the text reads "da lta'o" ("now") where the sense plainly requires "blta'o" ("gazed"); translated as "gazed." In the final verse, the phrase rendered "the four mighty māras, whom none could strike" is obscure in the Tibetan and the rendering is tentative. "Fragrances" in the ninth verse could alternatively be read as "questions."
• The phrase rendered "verses that poured forth like a shower" (chal dang 'dra ba) is uncertain in sense. The names of the buddhas and their world realms could not be confidently matched to Sanskrit forms and are translated by meaning. Blo gros bzang po is given as Sumati, though Bhadramati is also possible. The repeated "and so on, up to" reflects the Tibetan abbreviation of a stock passage. In the line on the wish-fulfilling tree, 'bru chags is read as "longing for the fruit (grain)". It might instead denote grain-eating birds that frequent the tree; the sense is uncertain. In "the stakes of the grounds, the masteries and the sacred pledges," dbang is taken in its sūtra sense of the bodhisattva masteries (vaśitā), not tantric empowerment.
• The names of the two buddhas and of the zenith world system and its bodhisattva are translated by meaning, since a reliable Sanskrit form could not be confirmed. Possible reconstructions are Ratnapadmasupratiṣṭhitaśailendrarāja for the buddha of the nadir and Raṇavijayaśrī for the buddha of the zenith. The verb □□□□□□ is read as the evident □□□□□□, "sent forth." The variant spelling □□□□□□□ is taken as □□□□□□□, the Sahā world. The phrase "up to" (bar du) marks passages the Tibetan abbreviates; it is rendered "and so on, up to," as in the preceding passage.
• A few descriptive terms in the portrait of the wrathful form are uncertain: "searing" for gzangs can, "hooked, squat nose" for sna sgar sgur can zhom pa lta bu, and "cut to pieces" for 'tshog par byed. The "mare beneath the sea" refers to the submarine fire of Indian cosmology (vaḍavāmukha).
• Several names in the closing homage list are rendered by meaning because their Sanskrit forms cannot be identified with confidence: "the Vajra Thunderbolt" (literally "vajra meteoric iron", perhaps Vajrāśani), "the Vajra Club" (perhaps Vajradaṇḍa), "the Red-Limbed Vajra", and "the Soaring One". "The seven perfectly awakened buddhas" presumably refers to the seven buddhas of the past.
• The phrase that opens the second paragraph (kha cig tu, literally "in some") is rendered "In some versions." It seems to mark a variant reading taken into the text. It could also mean "in some places." In the list of heavens, 'od gsal is taken as the Ābhāsvara (Clear Light) heaven

rather than the doctrinal term "luminosity." The word rendered "proclaimed by name" (mnas bsgags, probably for mtshan bsgrags) is somewhat uncertain in form. The heaven 'phrul dga' is kept as Sunirmita for consistency with this text's other pieces; its usual Sanskrit name is Nirmāṇarati.

• The Tibetan reads "all the great times" (dus chen po) as what the waters filled. This appears to be a slip for "the great earth" (sa chen po), and it has been translated that way. In the verse, stobs po che dang ldan pa is taken as the name Mahābala, the wrathful deity, in line with this text's other drafts: "together with Mahābala, tame the four māras." It could also be read as an epithet, "endowed with great strength."

• "Dunlé" (dun las) is an unidentified gem name, left in phonetics. The verse line rendered "alone upon an earth of a single hue" (sa mdog gcig pur) is obscure, and its sense is uncertain. In the line "the unbearable hells of the mind" (sems dmyal), sems may stand for sems can, giving "the unbearable hells of beings." In "you shall not harm them," the Tibetan reads 'tsho ba ("sustain"), which is taken as a slip for 'tshe ba ("harm"). The meaning of mi bgrungs pa, rendered "the impure," is uncertain. "Snake-holders" and "sādhakas" are literal renderings of class names that cannot be identified with confidence.

The long list of gods, spirits, and hosts of grahas ends in the Tibetan with the agentive particle kyis, which would make these beings the speakers. The context shows that they are the ones addressed. The speech commands the hostile spirits, and the hostile spirits later reply, "Sons of noble family, we shall act just as you command," addressing the wrathful ones. The list is therefore read as the audience of the wrathful ones' speech, taking kyis as standing for la. The word yang ("further") marks the wrathful ones continuing to speak.

The sentence about the passage "to be supplied" is the text's own abbreviation instruction: the preceding list of beings is to be repeated before their reply.

• The passage on the imputed, the dependent and dependent origination draws on the Yogācāra three-nature terminology (parikalpita, paratantra). It renders these as "imputed" and "dependent on another."

The phrase "it is otherwise beyond everyone, except insofar as it has become the domain of the Tathāgata's eye" renders a terse construction with ma gtogs ("except"). Its exact scope is slightly ambiguous.

The clause rendered "self is empty of self" (bdag gis stong) may instead mean "those that are empty are empty of self." It is read here in parallel with the following "other" and "both."

• "Concordant outcome of merit" renders bsod nams kyi rgyu mthun pa (Skt. likely puṇyaniṣyanda), a result that corresponds to its cause. The wording matches the rendering in the preceding passage. In the account of the accumulation of wisdom, the Tibetan repeats gso ba ("healing, nourishing") twice. This may be a scribal corruption of another term from the list of the doors of liberation, such as signlessness or wishlessness, but it is translated as written. Here nam mkha' mtha' yas skye mched is the formless "sphere of infinite space," not the name Ananta.

• The phrase rendered "the path by which every state is transformed" is obscure in the Tibetan. It may allude to the transformation of the basis (āśrayaparāvṛtti), but this is uncertain. The verbs "uttered these inspired words" render the term for udāna. In the long purpose clause I have put the closing statement, "I shall explain a little," first, so that the sentence can be followed when read aloud. "Through this presentation" renders rnam grangs 'dis, literally "by this enumeration" or "by this way of putting it."

• Two flower names, "Released-and-Held" and "All-Arising," are translated literally because their Sanskrit equivalents could not be identified with confidence. In the list of spirits, "sādhakas" (Tibetan sgrub pa) follows the rendering used elsewhere in this text; what kind of

being is meant is uncertain. The classes rendered "serpent-holders" and "oppressors" are literal translations of uncertain Sanskrit originals. The class rendered "skandas" is a Tibetan rendering normally used for Skanda and his seizing spirits. The final sentence, "no one else can send me away," interprets a terse phrase. It could also mean "I come and do not depart unless dismissed," or "I come without being sent by another."

• The long name of the buddha who gave Vajrapāṇi this heart essence could not be identified with a Sanskrit form and is rendered by meaning; its division into epithets is tentative. The verb □□□□□□□□ in Ānanda's instructions is uncertain and is rendered "keep it." □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as "I shall act as instructed," with □□□ in the sense of command or instruction, not scripture.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.